

Motivation Letter

MSc in International Business: Sustainable Finance, Maastricht University

To the Admissions Committee,
School of Business and Economics
Maastricht University

My undergraduate education in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence at Nanyang Technological University has provided a strong quantitative foundation, confirmed by an 88th percentile score in the quantitative section of the GMAT Focus Edition (595 overall) and an IELTS Academic score of 8.5. My coursework and applied projects have demonstrated that consequential business problems, particularly those at the intersection of finance and sustainability, require structured economic reasoning and managerial frameworks that a computing degree alone does not provide. This recognition directs my application to the MSc in International Business: Sustainable Finance, which I regard as an academically necessary and intellectually deliberate step toward building the specialized knowledge required to bridge the gap between quantitative financial analysis and strategic sustainability management.

I have actively sought to bridge my technical training with managerial principles by completing minors in Business (Banking and Finance Specialization) and Communication Studies, accumulating 60 ECTS across 10 business modules. Courses in Corporate Finance (A-), Marketing for the 21st Century (A-) and Fundamentals of Management (A+) introduced functional business frameworks, while advanced modules in Alternative Investments (A) and Consumer Insights (A-) required applying analytical reasoning to unstructured problems such as asset class evaluation and quantitative survey design. My performance in Alternative Investments, in particular, confirmed my aptitude for the principles of impact investing and non-traditional asset classes that are central to sustainable finance. These results confirm my aptitude for business disciplines but also reveal the limits of what elective coursework can achieve without a systematic grounding in the principles of sustainable finance and investment.

My academic projects reinforced this assessment. I developed a complete valuation model and investment committee memorandum for a leveraged buyout of Nilörngruppen AB, a Swedish labeling company, which required financial modeling under uncertainty and assessing ESG integration risks. I structured a quantitative consumer behavior study of over 200 respondents for Oatside, a plant-based food-and-beverage brand, and conducted a brand audit for Starbucks across international markets, evaluating corporate sustainability commitments against brand strategy, both of which demanded translating data into actionable business intelligence for managerial decision-making. My final-year project, developing an ethical decision framework for AI systems, directly corresponds with the governance component of ESG, confirming that effective corporate governance of technology requires a deeper understanding of how organizations manage non-financial risks and make ethical decisions. Each of these projects exposed the gap between possessing analytical capability and applying it within the systematic sustainable finance frameworks that drive long-term value creation.

To transition from my technical background to a strategic management role in sustainable finance, I recognize the need to build a systematic and rigorous foundation in this field. My goal is to complement my project-based experience in finance and marketing with the structured theoretical knowledge that a rigorous master's curriculum assumes. The MSc in International Business: Sustainable Finance at Maastricht University is my deliberate choice to acquire this comprehensive grounding. Its curriculum, with courses in Sustainable Corporate Finance and Valuation (EBC4211), Climate Finance and Investment (EBC4282), and Impact Investment and Measurement (EBC4212), offers the methodical instruction in applying financial techniques to address complex sustainability challenges that I require. The School of Business and Economics' triple-crown accreditation (AACSB, EQUIS, AMBA), placing it among the top one percent of business schools worldwide, and its Problem-Based Learning approach, which develops the critical thinking, teamwork, and problem-solving skills that this specialization demands, align precisely with my objective of working at the intersection of data analytics and corporate strategy within an international business context. Maastricht's position at the crossroads of European business, with direct industry links to firms such as DSM-Firmenich, a global leader in

sustainability-driven innovation, further reinforces the program's capacity to prepare graduates for leadership roles in sustainable finance.

My application is driven by the recognition that a career in sustainable finance demands a correct and complete intellectual foundation. My quantitative record and applied project experience indicate my readiness for this rigorous training. I am prepared to commit completely to this essential stage of my academic development and welcome the opportunity to discuss my application.

Sincerely,

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